

PRELUDE XXII

A MOVEMENT slow, but not too slow; rather an *Andante largamente* at four in the bar than an *Adagio* at eight. The main theme should be delivered as lasting from the entry of the treble to its third quaver in the third bar. On the second quaver of that bar the bass answers it and leads into bar 5. Then the single  figures are developed, direct and inverted. With the fifth quaver of bar 7 a fresh start is made, leading eventually to a close in the dominant on bar 13. (Bring out the main theme in the alto of bar 12.) In bars 13 and 14 the single figures are again broken off as in bar 5, but notice that the crotchets are no longer dotted or tied to quavers. From bar 15 onwards bring out the bass, first as being in canon with the treble, and then on its own account as leading to low notes implying full tone. From the second quaver of bar 20 Bach rises to a great climax, marked by his extreme measure in the use of chords massed in handfuls. Such a chord as that under the pause should be slightly broken. After this crisis a relapse into quieter tone will enable the last soprano sustained note to be heard dying away through the final cadence. All long notes should continue to sing through the harmonies; hence one reason for a not too slow *tempo*. Notice that, except for some extra notes in bars 1, 2, the end of 12, and from 20 to the end, the whole piece is in clear four-part harmony. All merely accompanying repeated quavers in the bass should be very nearly tied, as Bach constantly indicates in his orchestral music by slurs without the dots which editors insist on supplying. Bach means the *louré* stroke, such as Chopin uses in pairs of quavers in the B minor Prelude. The rhythms of the filling-out parts  and  should have their character asserted. The parts have in the present edition been assigned to the hands with special care to this end. When the player has mastered the intention he can do what he pleases as to the means.

FUGUE XXII

THIS is a Stretto Fugue with no Countersubject. The whole material for theme and counterpoint is given in the first two bars, except the long sequence in three-minim steps across the alla-breve bars extending from the middle of bar 5 to the middle of bar 12. Beginning thus while only two voices have entered, and covering the next two entries, this sequence includes Episode 1, and is reproduced later with a third voice, as Episode 3 (bars 42-45). Episode 2 (bars 17-24) leads to the first full close, in D $\flat$. Its otherwise not specialised line is more or less resumed in Episode 4 (bars 57-67), which leads to the final Stretto. The rest of the counterpoint throughout the Fugue is made by the four descending crotchets of the Subject, and their inversion as four ascending crotchets, shown at the outset in bars 2-3 and 4-5. Do not, however, break the flow of the crotchets in order to bring out this inversion. The crotchets, once begun, should go their way in peace: the important thing to bring out is their entry after each crotchet-

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rest. Thus, in the final Stretto (bars 67-76), no amount of emphasis on the six descending minims will enable a single-keyed instrument to show that they are really ten minims overlapping in five voices; the full opportunity of revealing the meaning of the five voices comes with the crotchet figures, to which Bach draws attention by his part-directing lines. Other entries needing special attention are as follows: at bar 27 (which must not be forestalled by the almost accidental minims in bar 26); the very unexpected syncopated entry in bar 46; the two-part Stretto at bar 50, followed again by minims in the bass which, though doubtless allusive, must not be allowed to weaken the entry in bar 53; and the simultaneous two-part entry in bar 55, where the lower member requires at least as much tone as the upper. The entry of the crotchets requires further special care when it strikes a unison, as in bar 33.

The *tempo* is a slow two in the bar, such as would be an easy-going four but for the absence of a second accent. The scheme is evidently a straightforward growth from a quiet opening to a great climax. The quieter the opening, the easier it will be to economise tone effectively; and a welcome opportunity for relaxing the tension is provided after the close in *Ab* at bar 37. Tied notes may often be unobtrusively repeated, especially when they are important suspended discords.

Between bars 29 and 37 the second part from the top crosses below the third, and the tangle of parts right up to bar 53 has confused even the editor of the *Bach-Gesellschaft*. Bischoff has cleared it up by a careful analysis of the MSS.; and the solution is here expressed in the notation, with the help of rests showing which parts are silent.